School of the
ARTS AND ARCHITECTURE : Art

Nomination for UCLA Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award

Dear Committee Members:

I am currently an Associate Professor of Art in the Photography Area. Although I have been teaching for 23 years now, my first UCLA undergraduate course was Special Topics Advanced Photography in the Spring of 2025 in which Ashley Hannah was my TA. Throughout the course, Ashley served a role that exceeded our department's expectations of Teaching Assistants: she held one-on-one student meetings, contributed to my syllabus, and hosted her own lectures. More than that, she served as a trusted collaborator for me as I was introduced to the culture of the program. She is a very sensitive and thoughtful educator who was particularly gifted when students struggled personally and academically. Her instructor evaluations, ongoing mentorship with former students, commitment to professional development workshops, and pursuit of advanced-level coursework in Diversity & Student-Centered Pedagogy show what is already obvious to me: Ashley is among the most talented, passionate, and dedicated student-teachers I've encountered, and is more than deserving of the Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award. It is an honor to work with and nominate her for this recognition.

To understand Ashley's contributions to our class, it's important to note that studio-based art classes require a combination of technical instruction, creative development, and critique which is the way we engage with and evaluate student work as a collaborative public dialogue. Critique demands the capacity to engage in a public dialogue about art works whose context may include students' personal stories, struggles, family life, identity, political and religious views, and other difficult topics. Ashley was not only crucial to creating an open and supportive environment for our community dialogue, but also demonstrated an ongoing eagerness to listen, support, and meet students' individual needs. She asked difficult questions, provided resources, and acknowledged the topics and themes that many others might not address.

To highlight Ashley's compassionate and effective teaching methodology, I'd like to share a few significant moments that highlight her maturity, thoughtfulness, and compassion as an educator:

1. Having difficult conversations about progress, which prompt growth.
   During our midterm reviews, Ashley and I met with each student individually. One student, in particular, struggled to make satisfactory progress on their final project and was at risk of failing the course. While it would have been easier to downplay their position, Ashley spoke honestly and provided an opportunity for recovery. With her motivation, the student made exceptional progress, pushing themselves outside of their comfort zone and developing a rich and experimental body of photographic work. At the end of the quarter, the student directly credited that conversation with Ashley for their renewed motivation.

2. Holding space for students.
   In our class, students tackled subjects including race, religion, addiction, gender identity, sexuality, and more. In addition to the subject matter explored through their projects, students struggled with mental health, difficult home life, and diverse learning needs. For each of these, Ashley engaged in vulnerable and honest conversations, and provided resources to on-campus and off-campus resources. To accommodate student needs, Ashley created quieter classroom environments, alternative assignments when absences were unavoidable, and redesigned our critique methodology for several sessions. More than anything, Ashley made our

students feel understood and cared for. Her compassion was palpable, which was reiterated through her many evaluations.

3. Ongoing mentorship with students.
   Ashley's one-on-one mentorship has transcended our classroom, and she continues to meet with former students to discuss their projects and provide motivation today. In these meetings, she remains student-centered: meeting them where they are, asking students what they'd like to get from their conversations, and providing motivation and direction in the form of informal assignments. In this way, she has helped many undergraduates develop and sustain a creative practice, even when inspiration ebbs and flows.

I can't imagine having taught my first UCLA undergraduate course without Ashley's insights and contributions. Because of her, we were able to build something special that I will take with me for many years to come.

Please don't hesitate to let me know if you have any additional questions about Ashley's candidacy or contributions.

Best,

Tarrah Krajnak
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Self Statement for Distinguished TA Award

My love for photography is eclipsed only by my love for teaching—a passion that has been with me, in one form or another, since middle school. When I walk into the photography department, I feel at home. Immediately, I'm greeted by former students, eager to discuss project updates and life events. I'm caught up in a beautiful, energized flurry: meeting with students-turned-friends, professors, and photography lab managers who have become family. This community and its warm embrace is a testament to the effort, care, and intention that I pour into each of my classes. Every time, it's a beautiful reminder of why I teach.

While completing my MFA in Photography at UCLA, I dedicated myself equally to my studio practice and to teaching. There, I independently sought coursework in Diversity & Student-Centered Pedagogy (EC 404), served as a teaching assistant for introductory and advanced photography courses, redesigned and taught our department's TA training practicum (ART 495) for first-year graduate students, and served as the lead teaching artist at local nonprofit, Venice Arts. Each quarter, teaching served an equally vital role as making, reaffirming my love for education and refining a radical teaching philosophy based on compassion and student-centered learning.

As the Teaching Assistant Consultant for the Art Department's TA Training Practicum (Art 495), I re-designed our curriculum to prioritize student-led discussions, incorporated intentional community-building, and employed flexibility and compassion in the wake of the 2024 election. To begin our course, I challenged students to read *From Safe Spaces to Brave Spaces*, prompting them to critique respectability politics, challenge traditional community norms, and collaboratively define conditions for a brave classroom instead. From there, I designed the course around weekly seminar-style conversations that tackled pedagogical concerns, allowing flexibility in the syllabus for students to determine portions of our readings. In doing so, I recognized and honored the experiences and knowledge of my peers and created a space where knowledge was truly co-created. In this course, I'm most proud of the empathy I was able to extend to my students in difficult moments. Whether holding space for a student who lost a family member, or taking a healing group walk following election day, my students noted the genuine care that I brought to our classroom.

As a Teaching Assistant in the Photography Department, I've had the honor of delivering technical skills, guiding conceptual and theoretical discussions, and challenging students to push themselves and their work. Perhaps my favorite part of teaching photography is its request for vulnerability: art asks students to be brave, honest, and challenging. As a Teaching Assistant, I've worked hard to make space for student exploration of difficult topics, never shying away from asking difficult questions and providing resources for support when needed. In these courses, I host individual student meetings, facilitate discussions based on dense photo history and theory, alter critique formats to fit student needs, and continue providing mentorship to students far beyond our courses. More than anything, my teaching evaluations note inclusivity, a productive balance of genuine support with rigorous challenge, and a true concern for students. I bring these same values to every class I teach.

Outside of the Photography Department, I've TA'd for courses such as *Arts Encounters: Exploring Arts Literacy in the 21st Century* and *Arts Education: From Viewing To Engagement*, exposing primarily non-art students to diverse art fields. In these courses, I urged students to connect art to their respective disciplines, personal experiences, and interests, seeing immediate buy-in from once-shy students who embrace the messy, challenging, and liberatory powers of art. Through seminar-style discussions, creative projects, and community-based workshop development, I supported students in using images from photographic archives as tools for inquiry and intervention, making art accessible to wider audiences.

Beyond university teaching, I've worked extensively in community settings. At Venice Arts, I designed and taught a year-long introductory photography course for low-income middle school students. At the Dougherty Arts Center, I developed portfolio-building and professional development workshops for high school students. In each role, I created curriculum from the ground up and learned how to engage young audiences at different stages of their art careers.

As a teacher, I am continually revising and improving my implementation of student-centered, active, and inclusive teaching practices. Through coursework such as EC 404: Diversity and Student-Centered Pedagogy, and independently-sought professional development workshops such as the Survivor's Art Circle Toolkit, I work intentionally to become a better teacher with every course. Every time, it's an honor to learn with and alongside my students.

Thank you for your consideration for this recognition - it has been a true honor to serve as a Teaching Assistant at UCLA,

Ashley Michelle Hannah

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Teaching Philosophy

I teach, primarily, because I love it.

I love watching students light up as they witness the magic of film development, shocked every time an image emerges. I love seeing students perfect a print, dedicated to doing it technical justice. Or listening, in awe, as students make profound connections between history, theory, and their own work.

I teach, selfishly, because it inspires, motivates, and energizes me. It reminds me of why I fell in love with the medium, and renews my faith in its ability to enact change.

I teach because, one time, a compassionate photography teacher helped me believe that I could be an artist despite having studied science my entire life.

But I teach, also, because I believe it's important. I teach because I feel especially well-positioned to help young folks develop their voice and artistic confidence. I teach because I believe that one good teacher, who provides attention, support, and challenge, can shape the trajectory of a student's life and impact the world.

As a teacher, I believe the best instruction happens in the fragile, generative space between challenge and support, where students are encouraged to take risks, reframe ideas, and discover their own voices. Creating the classroom conditions to support this kind of inquiry requires intention: in community-building, student-centered learning, critical reading and dialogue, empathy, and professional support. These areas form the pillars of my pedagogy, which I apply to studio-based and seminar-based classes alike.

Building a Brave Classroom Community

During the first week of class, I ask my students to read *From Safe Spaces to Brave Spaces,* prompting them to critique respectability politics, challenge traditional community norms, and collaboratively define conditions for a brave classroom instead. By asking students to think deeply about these conditions themselves, I give them the opportunity to actively shape their community while critically examining power, race, and systemic injustice from day one.

As a starting place, this exercise sets the tone for a class that asks students to challenge themselves, engage in difficult conversations, and help each other learn and grow. These norms are different than traditional communities norms: they ask us to rise to the occasion, to be brave in thought and discourse, and to challenge the status quo — lessons that are applicable to discussions as well as art making.

Student-Centered Pedagogy

In seminars and studio-based courses, I work hard to foreground student ideas, experiences, and questions. Whether tracing the history of photography, reading critical texts about photography's complicated relationship with truth and violence, or discussing contemporary art, I encourage students to confront challenging histories, ask probing questions, and connect historical contexts

to their own work and practice. Facilitating when needed, I employ this student-centered approach to create an environment where students feels empowered, mutually responsible, and included, while reinforcing a non-hierarchical learning environment where everyone, myself included, learns from each other.

Within introductory studio-based courses, I recognize that it's difficult to avoid banking models of education while delivering technical instruction. To counteract this hierarchical method of instruction, I encourage students to help each other, learn experientially, and ask for collective input. When students bring me darkroom prints for advice, I ask first for their own thoughts. In critiques, I refrain from commenting until the end, centering the voices of peers. In short: I become a facilitator and a cheerleader. I provide the tools and encourage experimentation, trial-and-error, and co-created knowledge. In doing so, I empower students to take charge of their education and art practice, serving as a guide rather than a commander.

Critical Discourse
Among many texts, I believe every aspiring photographer should engage with *The Civil Contract of Photography* (Azoulay), *In, Around, and Afterthoughts on Documentary Photography* (Rosler), *Camera Lucida* (Barthes), *On Photography* (Sontag), and *In Our Glory: Photography and Black Life* (hooks). These texts are challenging: dense, difficult to read, and heavy. They require an existential questioning of photography, its complicity in violence, and the camera's innate exploitation.

When assigning difficult texts, I remind students that theory requires patience, diligence, and joint effort. I don't expect students to make sense of every piece of a text, rather I encourage them to grapple with texts together, to sit with them over a period of time, and to reach clearer understanding through lively discussions. At the end of these discussions, which often turn existential, I help re-center students, probing them to consider why we continue to make photographs despite the medium's fraught legacy and connotations. Together, we identify our purpose, hopes, and motivations for making, informing our work as much as the theory itself.

Modeling Empathy, Flexibility, and Care
Perhaps my biggest asset as a teacher is my ability to make students feel seen, heard, and important. This comes from a genuine empathy, curiosity about students' experiences, and flexibility employed through my pedagogy. Whether altering a lesson in response to world events, hosting individual meetings to address goals and challenges, or asking important but difficult questions, I model intentional care, empathy, and flexibility for my students. This is the trait most mentioned in my student evaluations: a calming disposition that balances genuine support and with challenging rigor.

Professional Practice
And, finally, I believe that professional development is essential to fostering long-term art careers. In each of my courses, I teach students to draft and revise compelling artist statements, create professional CVs, and navigate the world of open calls, grants, and residencies. These practical skills, which tend to be overlooked, are crucial to preparing students for post-grad success, helping them sustain their art outside of the institution.

Truthfully, I teach because there is nothing in this world that I would rather do.

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Teaching Evaluations from Introduction to Darkroom Photography, Winter 2024:

These excerpts are from my first teaching experience at UCLA. Here, I'm most proud that students identified the care and attention I direct to every student in the class. In this course particularly, my calm, caring, and methodical demeanor was a huge asset, balanced against a very energetic and sometimes-scattered professor.

4.1) Please identify what you perceive to be the real strengths and weaknesses of this teaching assistant and course.

- Ashley has been overall the most helpful, knowledgable, easy-going, and comforting TA I have ever had in my two years here at UCLA. Every day she came to class prepared. She helped the whole class with different questions and issues we had. She would go out of her way to make sure we understood what was going on in the class and how to achieve the better or even the best results. She expanded not only the professor's ideas but also ours, she did a very great good at seeing our points while still adding her point of view. She was an overall very helpful TA who truly knew what she was doing. Her only weakness is she is overworked without getting the credit she deserves. 10/10 BEST TA!!!
- Ashley is a gifted teacher and added tremendous value to the class. She was supportive of the professor but also weighed in with valuable insights continually throughout the class. She was constantly available to me and gave hands-on coaching to help me when I was stuck. For example, I was developing in the dark room and she helped me understand specific ways to run tests that would help me quickly narrow in the right development strategy. She also is well read and deeply intelligent, often offering her perspective on readings and critiques that helped me see both the work I was making and the medium of photography in general in new ways. I believe she is an enormous asset and highly recommend her to future classes and professors. I hope to work with her again.
- Ashley is an AWESOME TA. Quietly brilliant and undeniably talented, she brings so much care and knowledge to class conversations, presentations, and to technical inquiries about photography. Ashley's

Teaching Evaluations from Art 495, Fall 2024

These evaluations highlight my commitment to hearing all voices and perspectives in the classroom, a powerful example for future educators in our TA training practicum (Art 495).

2.11) Please give the reasons for your rating in response to the above prompt.

- As a class we had diverse perspectives. We talked a bit about situations that could arise in class. We did an early good reading on safe spaces and critiques of them that featured conversation about identity.

- Ashley was very open in addressing everyone and leading an inclusive, healthy co-collaborative discussion that felt inclusive and demonstrated a welcoming approach to each individual in the class. Or so I thought.
- Hannah provided us with ample space to bring non-dominant perspectives to the conversation and this specific class. Student work definitely added tons of this to the environment and Hannah welcomed it. Overall the environment was great and accepting.
- Inclusive of everyone
- This class felt very inclusive and encouraged everyone to share their perspectives. We also touched on materials that helped me understand perspectives differenrent from mine as well
- We had many discussions about making sure we consider where everyone might be coming from, and that we might not know someone's background or reasoning for why they make their choices.
- they were very helpful and considerate beyond even what I think of for almost all aspects of the class.

2.7) Please give the reasons for your ratings in response to the above two prompts.

(For example, consider commenting on the extent to which you were encouraged to ask questions and engage in dialogue or other group activities that gave you the opportunity to reflect on what you were learning.)

- Ashely made room for really great discussions and held space for everyone to speak their mind.
- Ashley gave a lot of space for us to respond and participate in class discussion.
- Made sure to keep timing and flow of class balanced so everyone could retain attention and participate
- The co-collaboration in knowledge building & student-led discussions were inclusive and fostered an engaging dialogue amongst our cohort.
- The instructor always raised questions to the group as a whole and everyone felt safe enough to participate in the class environment.
- Very comfortable and accepting environment
- We were all encouraged to go around and share feelings and perspectives. We could be really self

Teaching Evaluations from Advanced Photography, Spring 2025

This advanced photography course provided room for the most mentorship, as students worked on quarter-long independent projects. As a result, I was really able to challenge students, help them overcome barriers, and invest in the experiences and ideas of each student.

Comments
Hannah was a very thoughtful TA and very obviously dedicated herself to this job
Both Tarrah and Ashley made the class so amazing and were very supportive and flexible through out the quarter. The objectives of the class stayed clear and consistent throughout even when needed changes happened. The class I think is a really important one to critically think about the ways we interact with the medium of photography as artist, and there are so many lessons and conversations that I will be taking away.
Ashley was by far the most helpful teachers assistant iev ever come across. She always fostered a welcoming environment and was always more than willing to help me when I was in a creative block.

Comments
I was pushed to think in a different way and try new things
The TA and the Professor shared the same understanding on this matter. Refer to the answer provided above to the same question for the Professor.
Ashley challenged me to really consider my motivations behind why I make the kind of work I make. She pushed me to consider other forms of making, which turned out to be incredibly fruitful for my practice. Art-making is often deeply personal and heavy. Ashley is incredibly emotionally intelligent, kind, and met me where I was at with the things I was processing through my work.

Comments
I felt completely safe coming to Ashley with any questions I had and even when I was quiet, she always made sure to talk to me and make sure I was doing well.
The TA and the Professor shared the same understanding on this matter. Refer to the answer provided above to the same question for the Professor.
A kind, welcoming presence in the classroom who encouraged everyone to participate and kindly invited all perspectives.
Ashley is very equitable with her time, making sure to make time for each student's needs during class.

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Syllabus - Art 495: TA Training Practicum
This syllabus highlights weekly seminar-style discussions aligned with community-building, university-wide requirements, and pedagogy. In Week 4, I intentionally left space for students to communally select their second pedagogical reading, encouraging active participation and leveraging the knowledge and experiences of everyone. Because the department has historically had a difficult time meeting PSET requirements on time, I incorporated them into our weekly assignment, ensuring expectations were clear and requirements were met on time. In student evaluations, the addition of discussions in Week 2, Week 5, and Week 8 made a big impact, making students feel connected, included, and prepared for future teaching assignments.

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Art 495: Teaching Assistant Training Practicum

Fall 2024 - Wednesdays 10am - 12:50pm - The UCLA Department of Art
Location: UCLA Margo Leavin Graduate Art Studios and Broad Art Center

Instructors

Ashley Michelle Hannah, Associate Instructor. Email: ashley.michelle.hannah@gmail.com

Professor Andrea Fraser, Faculty Supervisor. Email: afraser@ucla.edu

Ashley's office hours: Wednesdays 1-1:30 PM or by appointment

Course description

Art 495 is mandatory for all new graduate students in the Department of Art. This course is a forum for first year graduate students in the Department of Art to discuss pedagogy, community, and resources available to TA's at UCLA. In this course, we will discuss and practice college-level teaching techniques that focus on active, student-centered learning and critical thinking. This course also provides an orientation to important university and departmental guidelines and policies. Throughout the fall quarter we will work together to build a supportive peer environment where any TA-related questions or concerns may be openly discussed with your new cohort.

Learning objectives

By the end of the course, TAs should be able to:

- understand their rights and responsibilities as TAs at UCLA;
- understand and implement the principles of transparent syllabus design;
- align teaching strategies with measurable learning objectives;

- implement active learning strategies;
- set norms and employ strategies that create inclusive classrooms;
- apply the principles of student-centered learning;
- demonstrate practical teaching skills acquired through microteaching;
- describe the role and importance of constructive feedback;
- distinguish between assessment and grading;
- use assessment as a tool for aiding student growth;
- address student needs and demands;
- measure and improve their own effectiveness as instructors;
- direct students and themselves to appropriate campus/departmental resources; and
- approach teaching as a profession.

Course requirements

- Passing the course requires your **attendance** and **participation**, **preparedness**, **completion of assignments**, as well as completion of the PSET course and three workshops from the Foundation of Teaching workshop series.
- More than one unexcused absence will result in an unsatisfactory grade.
- Absences may be excused for illness, medical procedures, or family emergencies. Please send me an email in such situations.
- A grade of unsatisfactory in this course will negatively impact future opportunities for TA appointments.

Assignments

1. Artist talk

Prepare a 10 minute presentation about your work. There will be 5 minutes for questions and discussion following your presentation. Artist talks will occur in Weeks 2-4.

2. Micro-teaching

In small groups (2-3 people), prepare and teach a concept to the class in 20 minutes. There will be 10 minutes for feedback and discussion on your teaching strategies following your presentation. Utilize backward design by setting your learning goals first, and designing the lesson to accomplish your goals. Micro-teaching will occur in Weeks 6 & 7.

3. Syllabus

Using learnings from your Foundations modules, pedagogy discussions, and group critique texts, prepare a syllabus for a studio class. Pay special attention to the Course Description, Philosophy for Group Critique, and Assignments sections of the syllabus. Syllabi are due prior to class in Week 9 (Nov 27).

Schedule

Week 1, October 2

- Introductions to one another
- Review syllabus and discuss course requirements

- Sign up for artist talk dates
- Tour of Broad, staff, campus, and student resources

- **Homework: Read "From Safe Spaces to Brave Spaces" by Arao & Clemens**

Week 2, October 9

- Introduction to Andrea Fraser, faculty supervisor
- Discuss "From Safe Spaces to Brave Spaces" & draft community norms
- Artist talks begin

- **Homework: Complete "How Students Learn" module on BruinLearn, begin PSET courses**

Week 3, October 16

- Union orientation presentation by the UAW representatives of Local 2865
- Discuss How Students Learn module
- Artist talks continue

- **Homework: Complete Creating Inclusive Classrooms module on BruinLearn, continue PSET courses**

Week 4, October 23

- Presentation from Visiting Artist Lecture Series (VALS)
- Artist talks conclude
- Discuss & brainstorm micro-teaching assignment
- Decide on pedagogy reading for next week

- **Homework: Read Chapter 1 of Teaching to Transgress and _____ additional reading, selected by class.**

  (NOTE: the deadline to complete the Title IX compliance requirements is November 7)

Week 5, October 30

- Experienced TA Panel
- Q&A open forum: potential topics include CA residency classification, review days, open studios, departmental requirements, etc
- Pedagogy discussion: Teaching to Transgress, class-selected reading, and personal experiences
- Microteaching prep day

- **Homework: Complete Title IX compliance training**

Week 6, November 6

- Microteaching begins

- **Homework: Complete Assessment & Grading module on BruinLearn, finish PSET courses**

Week 7, November 13

- Microteaching concludes
- Discuss Assessment & Grading module
- Introduction to Syllabus design & syllabus assignment

- **Homework: Read Group Critique Readings**

Week 8, November 20

- Discussion section: group critique philosophy
- Discuss principles of student-centered learning, assessment, and grading
- Measuring and improving one's own effectiveness as an instructor

- **Homework: Finish syllabus assignment**

Week 9, November 27 (Zoom)

- Syllabus presentations

Week 10, December 4

- End-of-quarter party
- Opportunity for reflections and discussion on future TAing
- Complete course evaluations

Campus-wide TA training requirements

(the deadline may be subject to change)

As part of Art 495, incoming MFA must also satisfy three sets of campus-wide requirements that have been adopted to ensure that training for teaching assistants is consistent and of high quality across the university. The TA training requirements are evidence-based and grounded in pedagogical best practices in order to promote strong classroom learning environments for all UCLA students.
https://teaching.ucla.edu/gradstudent-programs/ta-training-requirements/#toggle-id-1

1. Professional Standards and Ethics Training (PSET) for TAs

(Deadline: Week 10, Fall Quarter)

The Professional Standards and Ethics Training (PSET) is offered as an online course in Bruin Learn and should take approximately 3.5-4 hours. You can satisfy the PSET by self-enrolling in the course. The course consists of the following modules and must be completed by Week 10 of the Fall Quarter:

- TA Ethics and Professional Responsibilities

- Promoting Learning through Diversity: The Inclusive Classroom
- Teaching Students with Disabilities
- Creating an Educational Environment Free of Violence and Sexual Harassment
- Fostering Academic Integrity

2. Foundations of Teaching workshop series

(Deadline: Week 10, Fall Quarter)

REQUIREMENT: In this 495 class, we will be completing the following units of UCLA's Foundations of Teaching curriculum: How Students Learn, Creating Inclusive Classrooms, Assessment & Grading.

Beginning in Fall 2024, UCLA's Foundations of Teaching curriculum consists of short asynchronous lessons in Bruin Learn (60 minutes or less) that will reinforce discussion and application in our 495 course. More information about completing the Foundations of Teaching requirement can be found on the Bruin Learn site for our 495 course.

Please note that each component of the curriculum includes an exit quiz. You can retake this quiz multiple times, but you are required to complete the exit quiz with a passing grade of 80% or better in order to satisfy UCLA's Foundations of Teaching requirement for TAs.

3. Title IX Compliance Requirements

(Deadline: Thurs, November 7, 2024)

All incoming graduate and professional students must complete TWO forms of sexual harassment and sexual violence prevention training - an online training AND a live virtual training.

- 1. Online Training: All incoming graduate and professional students are required to complete EVERFI's *Sexual Assault Prevention for Graduate Students,* an interactive online educational program. An invitation email from *EVERFI* will be sent out the first week in September 2022. This contains a link to the *Sexual Assault Prevention for Graduate Students* online training module; AND

- 2. Live Virtual Training: Aside from the online training, all incoming graduate students are also required to complete a live virtual training *Title IX Training for Graduate Students* facilitated by the Title IX Office. All incoming students must attend one of the graduate student sessions that will be offered throughout the first few weeks of the Fall quarter.

The schedule and sign-up links can be found on the following website:
https://grad.ucla.edu/academics/graduate-study/title-ix-compliance-training-for-new-graduate-students/

NOTE: Both training sessions must be completed by November 3, 2022. If they are not, a registration hold will be placed on your record for winter quarter.

RESOURCES AND POLICIES

Bias Reporting: UCLA is committed to maintaining a campus community that provides the strongest possible support for the intellectual and personal growth of all its members – students, faculty and staff.

Each must feel valued, welcomed and included. Acts intended to create a hostile climate that are directed at any of our members are unacceptable and have no place in our community. The True Bruin Respect program has been put in place to aid in responding to such acts. To file an online incident report, visit: https://ucla-advocate.symplicity.com/public_report/index.php/pid600576?

UCLA Conduct Policies: All students are expected to abide by the UCLA Student Code of Conduct and Principles of Community. Students are expected to engage in thoughtful reflection, exhibit superior ethical decision-making skills, and to respect the rights and dignity of all members of our community by listening attentively, communicating clearly, and remaining open to understanding others and diverse points of view https://www.registrar.ucla.edu/Registration-Classes/Enrollment-Policies/Class-Policies/Student-Conduct
Policies / https://www.ucla.edu/about/mission-and-values

COVID-19 Protocols: UCLA requires all Faculty, Staff, and Students to be up-to-date on vaccinations and to self-screen for COVID-19 symptoms. UCLA also requires students to report positive COVID tests to the Ashe COVID-19 hotline (310-206-6217), to isolate following a positive COVID test, and to quarantine following close contact to COVID-infected individuals. UCLA strongly recommends indoor masking. For detailed information, visit https://covid-19.ucla.edu/information-for-students.

Anti-Racism, Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion Statement and Resources: UCLA's Office for Equity, Diversity and Inclusion provides resources, events, and information about current initiatives at UCLA to support equality for all members of the UCLA community. Please let us know if you experience anything in this course that does not support an inclusive environment. You can report any incidents you witness or experience on campus to the Office of Equity, Diversity and Inclusion through their website (https://equity.ucla.edu).
LGBTQ Campus Resource Center: This resource center provides a range of education and advocacy services supporting intersectional identity development. It fosters unity; wellness; and an open, safe, inclusive environment for lesbian, gay, bisexual, intersex, transgender, queer, asexual, questioning, and same-gender-loving students, their families, and the entire campus community. Find it in the Student Activities Center, or via email lgbt@ucla.edu. Visit their website for more information: https://www.lgbt.ucla.edu

Sexual Harassment/Sexual Violence: Title IX prohibits gender discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking. If you have experienced sexual harassment or sexual violence, there are a variety of resources to assist you. CONFIDENTIAL RESOURCES: You can receive confidential support and advocacy at the CARE Advocacy Office for Sexual and Gender-Based Violence, via email CAREadvocate@careprogram.ucla.edu or by phone (310)206-2465. Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) also provides confidential counseling to all students and can be reached 24/7 at (310) 825-0768. NON-CONFIDENTIAL RESOURCES: You can also report sexual violence or sexual harassment directly to the University's Title IX Coordinator, via email at titleix@conet.ucla.edu or via phone at (310)206-3417. Reports to law enforcement can be made to UCPD at (310) 825-1491. These offices may be required to pursue an official investigation. Faculty and TAs are required under the UC Policy on Sexual Violence and Sexual Harassment to inform the Title IX Coordinator should they become aware that you or any other student has experienced sexual violence or sexual harassment.

Center for Accessible Education (CAE): Students needing academic accommodations based on a disability should contact the Center for Accessible Education (CAE) at (310)825-1501 or via their website (www.cae.ucla.edu.) When possible, students should contact the CAE within the first two weeks of the term as reasonable notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. If you are already registered with the Center for Accessible Education (CAE), please request your Letter of Accommodation on the Student Portal. If you are seeking registration with the CAE, please submit your request for

accommodations via the CAE website. Please note that the CAE does not send accommodation letters to instructors--you must request that I view the letter in the online Faculty Portal. Once you have requested your accommodations via the Student Portal, please notify me immediately so I can view your letter. Students with disabilities requiring academic accommodations should submit their request for accommodations as soon as possible, as it may take up to two weeks to review the request. For more information, please visit the CAE website (www.cae.ucla.edu) or contact them by phone at (310) 825-1501.

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS): CAPS supports student mental health needs as they pursue their academic goals. Their services are designed to foster the development of healthy well-being necessary for success in a complex global environment. CAPS offers a variety of services to meet student needs including: crisis counseling available by phone 24 hours a day/7 days a week 310-825-0768, emergency intervention, individual counseling and psychotherapy, group therapy, psychiatric evaluation and treatment, psychoeducational programs and workshops, and campus mental health and wellness promotion. Please visit http://counseling.ucla.edu for more information.

UAW2865 Union Contract: Know your rights and obligations as a TA instructor under the current Union contract. Applies to all graduate level instructors, not just those who opt for union membership. See: Current Contract | UCnet

LAND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The UCLA Department of Art acknowledges our presence on the traditional, ancestral and unceded territory of the Gabrielino/Tongva peoples.

Selection of recommended readings and resources on pedagogy

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Harris, Mary Emma (2002) *The Arts at Black Mountain College*, Cambridge, MA: MIT Press

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Madoff, Steven Henry (ed.) (2009) *Art School (Propositions for the 21st Century)*, Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
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Rancière, Jacques (1991) *The Ignorant Schoolmaster: Five Lessons in Intellectual Emancipation*, translated with an introduction by Kristin Ross, Stanford, CA: Stanford University Press.

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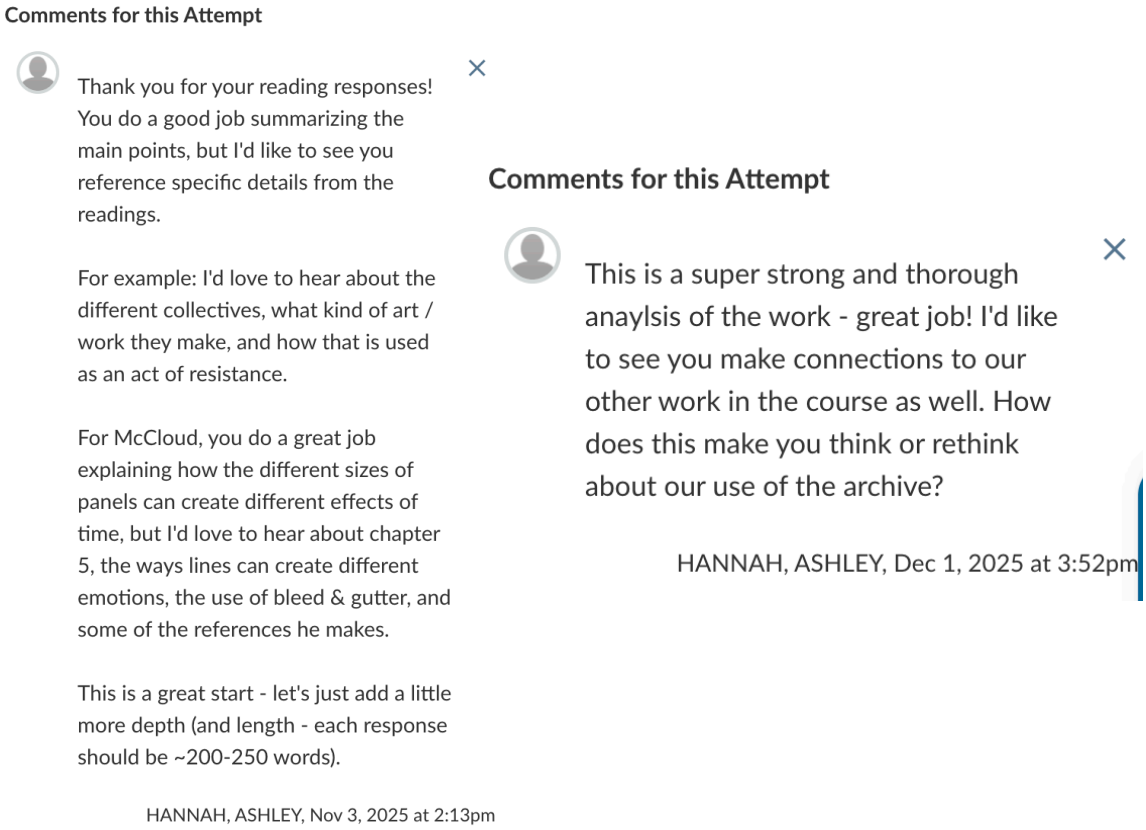
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ASHLEY MICHELLE HANNAH
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Feedback - Arts Ed: From Viewing to Engagement Reading Responses

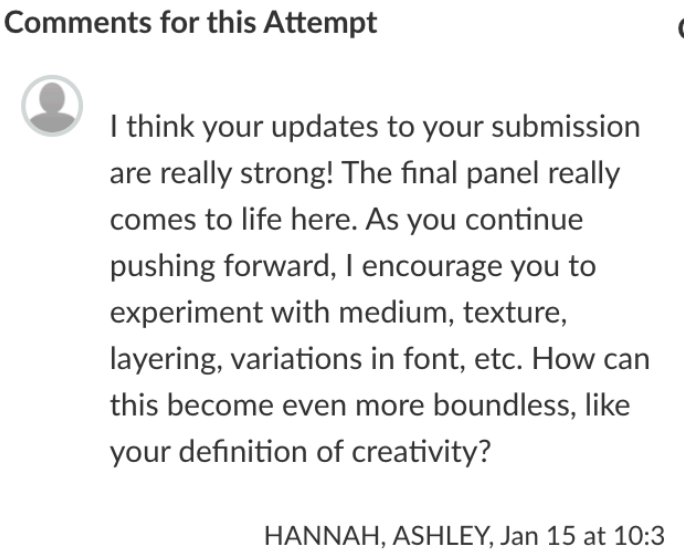
In Arts Ed 101, we asked students to engage with dense theoretical texts about the role of the photographic archive and its relationship to truth and violence. When providing feedback to students, I always reinforced the areas of success before prompting students to think about ways to improve. In the first example, I found the student's response to be slightly vague and lacking specificity. In my response, I highlighted the types of details and nuance we'd love to see. In the second example here, the student did an amazing job with the reading summary. Still, I encouraged them to push even further, prompting them to think about connections to other parts of the course.

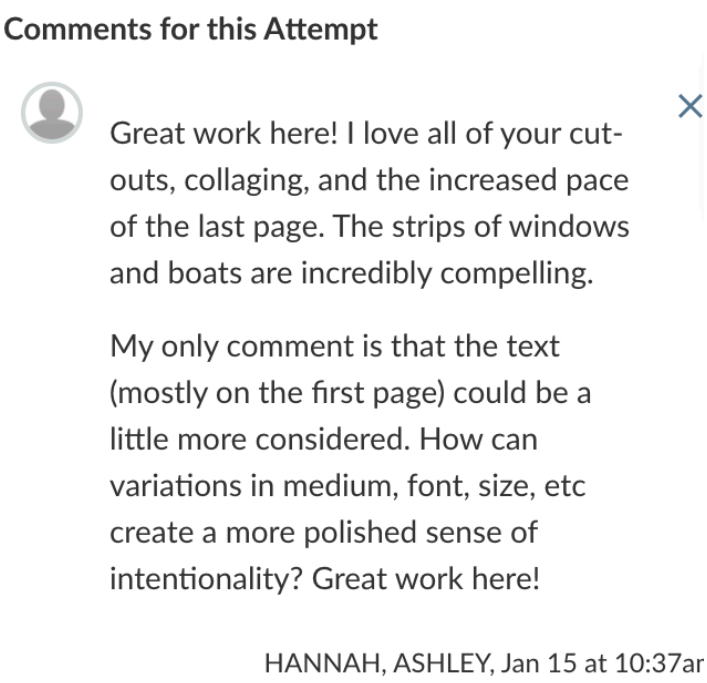


Feedback - AA10: Arts Encounters

In Arts Encounters, we ask non-art students to submit weekly creative assignments. For many of our students, this feels like a challenge, testing their artistic confidence. In my responses, I always start by providing encouragement before asking questions that prompt more intentional art choices. In the first example here, I use the student's own definition of art to encourage their continued exploration. In the second example, I make minor suggestions about the use of text in

the artwork. By posing my feedback in question format, I encourage students to use their own creativity to push forward in the class.





Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation
This award celebrates Teaching Assistants who demonstrate a pattern of effective teaching that incorporates current best practices (e.g., student-centered learning, active learning, inclusive teaching), aims to inspire and challenge students, and supports the success of all students.

Name Keegan Boyse

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)
I met Ashley last spring, when she was the TA for an Advanced Photography course taught by Tarrah Krajnak at UCLA. Beyond that class, she consistently goes above and beyond with her support; I often ask her for input/critiques on my work, and general academic and career advice.

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)
Throughout the course, Ashley was an avid advocate for students. From the beginning, she helped Tarrah (who was new to UCLA) amend the ambitious course syllabus to maintain important themes while assigning fewer readings, creating more time for productive and in-depth discussions. Throughout the quarter, she consistently met with students one-on-one, providing us with supplementary reading and artistic references specific to our quarter-long photographic projects. When I was struggling with my project, she gave me specific advice about how I could develop a methodology to clarify my direction and improve production. I met with her often before/after class, wherein she helped me with my project statement, installation decisions, and more. Building a conceptual project that didn't rely on a project statement was new and difficult for me, and led me to feel uncertain and lost in my work. Because Ashley was not afraid to ask difficult questions, I realized that my primary interest was formal, rather than conceptual. While it took me a long time to embrace that realization, I doubt that I would have ever reached it without Ashley's guidance and support.

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)
After midterm critiques for the Advance Photography course, it became apparent that our loose critique structure (or lack thereof), was negatively impacting students' ability to get productive critiques. Before Ashley's assistance, our class conversations often got stuck on one small or tangential aspect of a student's work, and students felt dissatisfied with the depth of feedback they received. Seeing this, Ashley proposed a new critique structure that she and her fellow graduate students had used. The results were immediate: there was an undeniable difference in the productivity of critique, and the overall energy and community within the class was vastly improved. Ashley's implementation of this structure on top of her willingness to engage in difficult conversations ensured a comfortable environment for students to share their thoughts, consider other perspectives, and engage in challenging aspects of photography. She did not shy away from discussing the ethical considerations and complicated history of photography, but

rather, directed students to thoughtfully engage in the medium and discover their own reason for making.

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)

Overall, Ashley is a positive presence in class and around campus. She has always made time to help students, whether or not they are in her class; between studio visits and one-on-one meetings to discuss work, she is someone who I (and many other students) rely on for advice and support. She is undoubtedly an outstanding candidate for this award, and I can say with confidence that my positive experience with her is not at all unique, as every student she has worked with has nothing but good things to say about her.

Name
Jacob Faulkner

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)
Ashley was my TA for Advanced Photography with Tarrah Krajnak in the Spring of 2025, and has continued mentoring me since then.

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)
Ashley balances gentleness and attentiveness to student needs while being direct and challenging. Coming into the class, I had been working primarily in representational photography. While I had been exploring performance on the side, Ashley challenged me to think about how my performance work exists within my photographic practice. She constantly encouraged me to think reflexively about my practice, examining why I was working within a specific aesthetic language, and what it might mean to move outside of it.

In other moments of the class, Ashley challenged students to think about the history and ethics of photography, providing insight into how she navigates the ethical complications that arise in the medium. In these discussions, one-on-one meetings, and critiques, Ashley consistently raised challenging questions, inspiring students to think critically about the work they were making. In these ways, and many others, Ashley helped me become a more thoughtful and bold artist.

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)
During one of Ashley's lectures, she opened the floor to questions about anything students wanted to learn: grad school, grants, residencies, art market, artistic practice, etc. She gave really practical advice, even sharing examples of how she has written grant applications, artist statements, and organizes her CV. It was refreshing to have a TA be so generous and candid with insider knowledge and resources related to navigating the art world.

Outside of class, Ashley continues to meet with me to discuss my practice. During these sessions, she starts by asking what I feel I need out of the meeting, whether that be encouragement, challenge, structure, etc. In this way, she opens the door for honesty. In many moments, I've needed an extra push and structure. To help, Ashley gives me "assignments" and schedules follow-up meetings, providing a level of structure that is often hard to find within studio-based classes. Every time she meets me where I am, and tailors her support to meet my needs.

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)
Ashley has been incredibly generous with her time, inside and outside of the classroom. Last

quarter, Ashley met with me multiple times, pushing me to develop strategies for sustaining my artistic practice and helping me work through burnout. She has also offered to help me improve my writing for grant/residency applications.

In my time at UCLA, I've never met a TA so willing to provide support and guidance beyond the parameters of a class. It's clear that she has a clear passion for teaching, and her mentorship has helped me and my practice tremendously.

February 12, 2026

Subject: Letter of Recommendation for Ashley Hannah - Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants

To the Selection Committee,

As the Photography Lab Area Supervisor in the Department of Art at UCLA, I oversee our darkroom, computer lab, photo studio, and equipment. Having worked with many TA's over the last decade, I am recommending Ashley for the Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants. She stands out because she is both technically proficient and genuinely supportive of the students.

In my role, a TA's effectiveness has a direct impact on my own daily work. When a lab runs efficiently during class time, I see a noticeable decline in equipment misuse and technical errors. Ashley is excellent at this; she has a strong command of both analog and digital processes, but more importantly, she knows how to spot a student's mistake before it ruins their work. For instance, in an Art 11b -Beginning Photography course, she noticed several students struggling with manual light metering. Rather than waiting for them to fail, she independently went to each student to offer a simplified explanation that helped them apply the lecture materials to actual camera usage.

Beyond the technical side, Ashley is a great resource for students trying to bring their ideas to life. She holds one-on-one meetings to help them conceptualize their work, providing the kind of guidance that turns a rough idea into a successful finished project. This type of individual attention is exactly what students need in a studio art setting.

Ashley's dedication was especially clear while she was TA'ing the Beginning Photography course. Despite an injury that made standing for long periods difficult, she was determined to stay available to her students. She used a stool in the darkroom so she could remain present during the four-hour studio blocks, ensuring that the students still had consistent support throughout the quarter.

Ashley is an excellent member of our department who ensures that students maintain high technical standards while feeling encouraged in their work. She has my highest recommendation for this award.

Sincerely,



Valerie Green

Photography Lab Area Supervisor

Department of Art, UCLA